

Investigation of the Learning Process Through Game Development

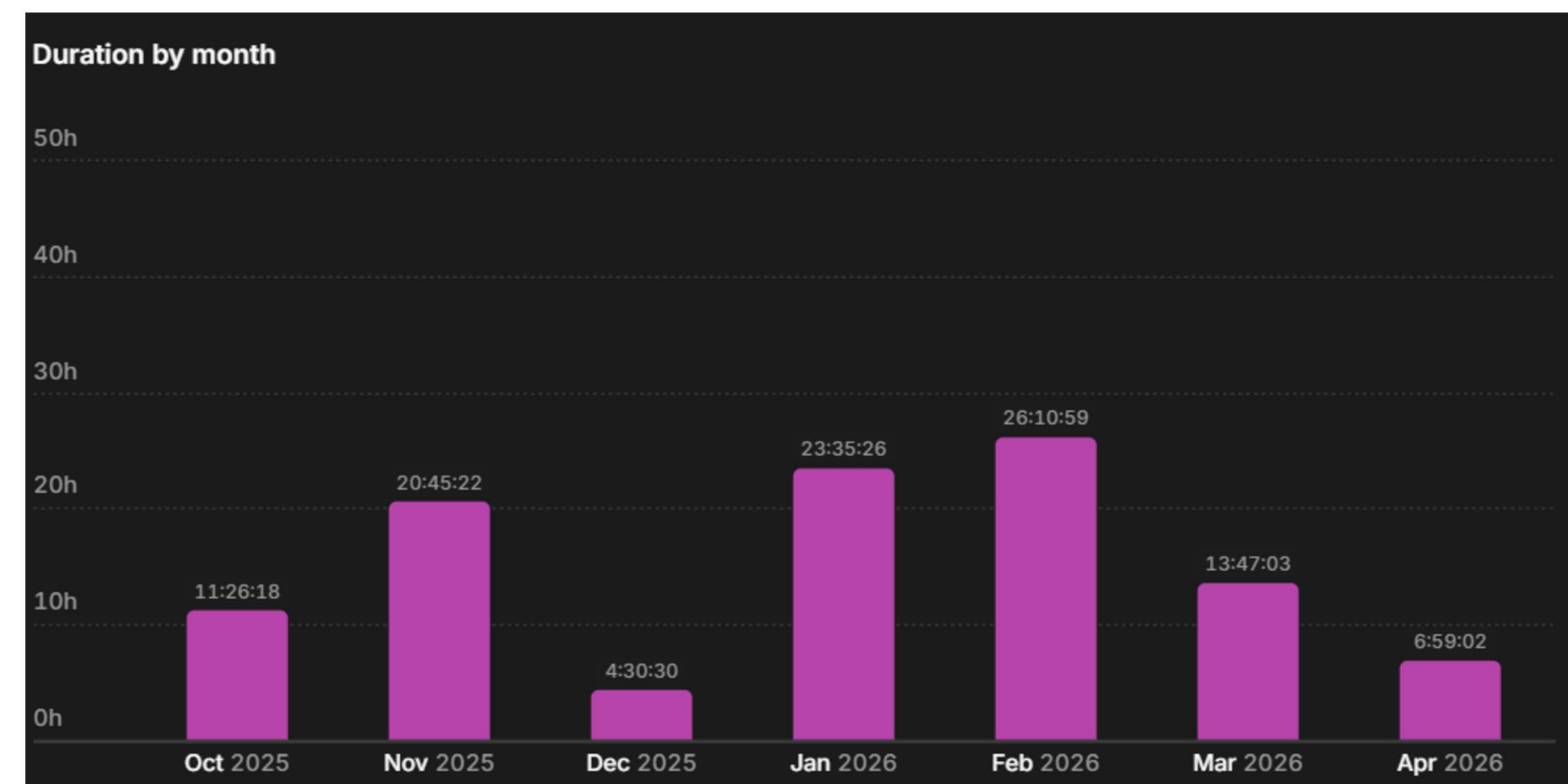
Background

- Learning is hard and many different factors can negatively impact it.
- A lot of research about specific skills and techniques in isolation but not how to navigate learning including the confounding variables of life.
- **Goal:** Learning about learning through making a video game.
- Game development was chosen to encompass many different fields and encounter new situations.

Methods

- Learning journal to track each day's work and findings
- Session lengths are also tracked to see variations over time and between logs
- Sprint Work Organization
 - ~2 weeks of time
 - Plan at start
 - Retrospective at end
- Utilized free resources
 - Godot 4.6 - Game Engine
 - Toggl Track - Time Tracker
 - Lucid Chart - Flowchart Creator
 - Blender 5.0 - 3D Modelling
 - YouTube & Online Forums - Game Development Skills

Results



Time Tracked from October 24, 2025 - April 23, 2026

Sprint

Log Title MM/DD/YYYY

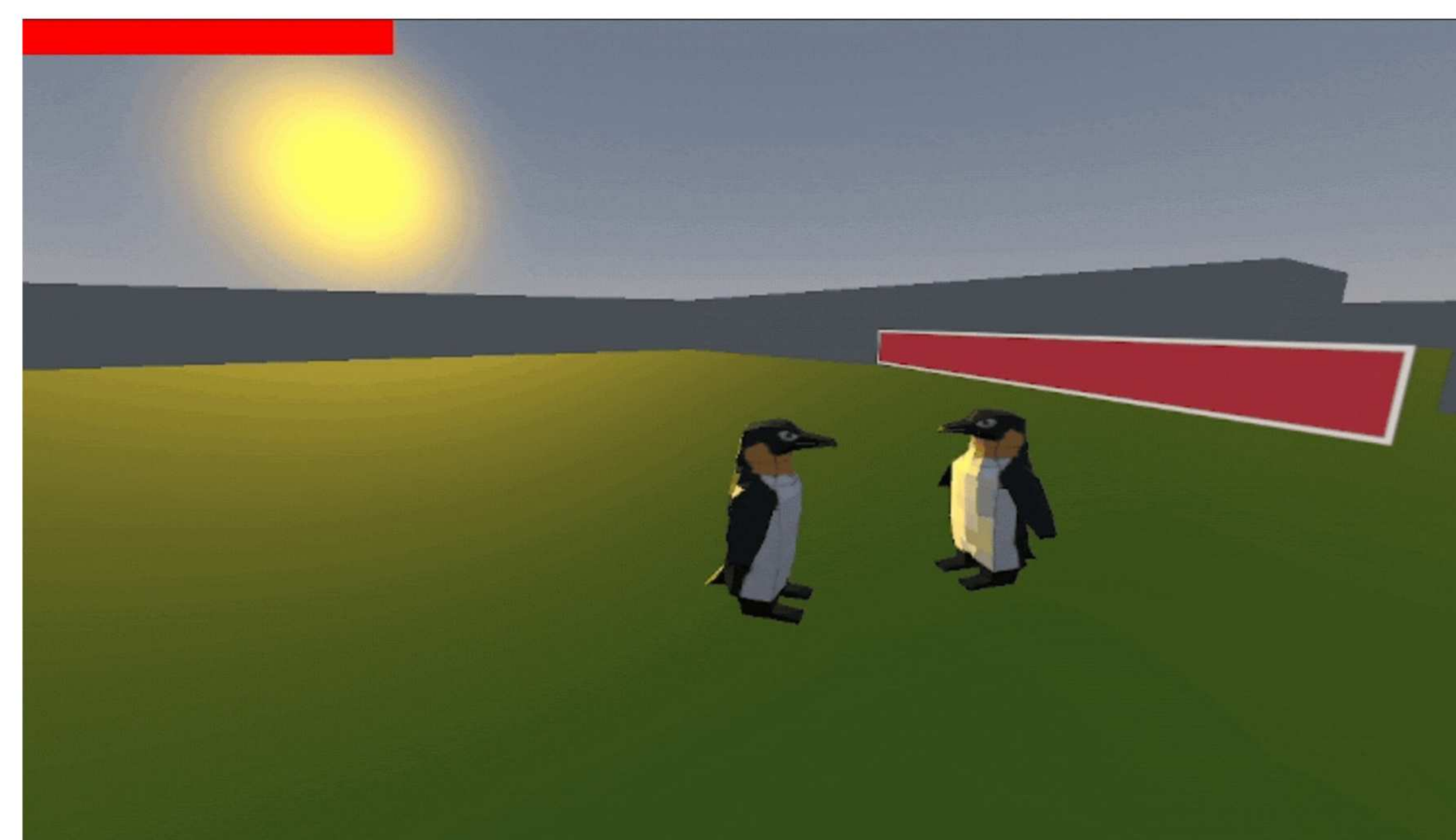
Summary:

Session Start Rating:

Notes

Session End Rating:

Notebook log Template



In-game screenshot of player and enemy

- Two types of logs
 - Reflection-heavy
 - Work-heavy
- Very cliché-like or common sense ideas
 - Be proud of the work being put in
 - Derive enjoyment from the process of work and not just the fruits of labor
- Without structure or specific goals, time put in fluctuates

Discussion / Conclusions

- Control external environment to create a more suitable work environment
- Work with others to receive validation and feedback on work done
- Hardest part is consistent practice
- Perfectionism caused biggest issues
 - Dissatisfaction with work
 - Disoriented sense of scale
- Internal and external conditions work hand-in-hand
 - Less doomscrolling

References

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- Langan-Fox, J., Armstrong, K., Balvin, N., & Anglim, J. (2002). Process in skill acquisition: motivation, interruptions, memory, affective states, and metacognition. Australian Psychologist, 37(2), 104–117. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00050060210001706746>
- Stanton, J. D., Sebesta, A. J., & Dunlosky, J. (2021, April 2). Fostering Metacognition to Support Student Learning and Performance. CBE—Life Sciences Education, 20(2), 7. <https://www.lifescied.org/doi/10.1187/cbe.20-12-0289>